VIA AIR MAIL · PAR AVION

Somewhere above the clouds

Dear Leo,

Thank you for your wonderful letter! A red Lego plane, just like my red plane? That made me smile all the way up to the clouds.

You asked if I was scared flying over the ocean all alone. Here is the truth: sometimes I was. The night was dark, a storm rumbled, and ice tried to stick to my wings. But I had practiced and practiced, and I knew my plane very well. Being brave does not mean you never feel scared. It means you keep going carefully, even when you do.

You also asked what I ate. On that long flight, I mostly sipped tomato juice through a straw! It kept me going for about fifteen hours, all the way to a farmer's field in Northern Ireland.

And you lost your first tooth! Congratulations, Leo. That is a big moment, a bit like a first flight.

Your friend in the sky,

Amelia

P.S. If you could fly your Lego plane anywhere in the whole world, where would you go?

REAL HISTORY

The true story behind Amelia's letter, for Leo and a grown-up to read together.

1. On 20–21 May 1932, Amelia Earhart became the first woman to fly solo nonstop across the Atlantic Ocean, in a red Lockheed Vega.
2. The flight took about 15 hours. She met storms and ice on the way, and landed safely in a farmer's pasture near Derry, Northern Ireland.
3. She reported that her only food on the flight was a can of tomato juice, sipped through a straw.
4. Storytelling: Amelia never wrote to children in the future. This letter imagines what she might say to Leo, using only true facts about her life.

Write back to Amelia!

Write here or on any paper you like. Then ask a grown-up to take a photo of it and upload it in your Letters from History account. Amelia's next letter will answer you.